major problem with Waltz's unit-structure relationship is that it leaves little or no room for systemic change induced by the units themselves.[16] He further argues that by emphasizing recurrence and repetition in the international system, neo-realism cannot envisage a form of statecraft which transcends the calculus of power and control. Cox (1986) places the neo-realist theory in the category of 'problem-solving approach' to international relations when this may be little more than a cover for and rationalization of immoral and unethical behaviour. By deconstructing realism, neo-realism and neo-liberalism, post-modern critical theory observes that the concept of inter-state anarchy is in reality an artificial construction of the dominant discourse and the state practices associated with it. It is contrived and generated by the dominant international relations discourse.[17]

There has also been a feminist critique of realist theory from the point of exclusion of the women throughout the whole discourse. The most common motif in feminist analyses of peace and war depicts masculinity as a transcendentally aggressive force in society and history. Women are bystanders or victims of men's wars. Most feminist commentary, through the 1980s, followed this framework. In particular, the extraordinary outburst of concern over the nuclear threat in the 1970s and early 1980s resulted in a spate of feminist writings explicitly or implicitly founded on a critique of masculinist militarism. In her appraisal of Hans J. Morgenthau, for instance, Tickner (1988) criticizes realism as only "a partial description of international politics", owing to its deeply embedded masculinist bias. But partial descriptions are partial descriptions; they are not dead wrong. Tickner attacks Morgenthau's paradigm on several grounds. But her main concern is to offer a *feminist reformulation* of certain realist principles. In a similar vein, the central problem may not be with objectivity as such, but with objectivity "as it is culturally defined ... [and] associated with masculinity". The idea of the "national interest" likewise needs to be rendered more "multidimensional and contextually contingent", but not necessarily abandoned. Tickner stresses: "I am not denying the validity of Morgenthau's work" but only asking for a negotiation with the 'contentious others'.[18]